

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 10 3
♥ Q 9 5
♦ J 9 8 6
♣ A 7 3

♠ A 8 2
♥ A 10 8 2
♦ A 3
♣ K Q 10 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 9 6 4
♥ J 7 3
♦ 10 5 2
♣ 5 2

♠ 7 5
♥ K 6 4
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ J 9 8 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North continuation. You win the third ♠ with your ♠A.

Partner's 2NT bid invites you to bid game if you have a maximum hand. Your 17 points is certainly a maximum so you bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠6. Will you take your ♠A immediately? or at trick 2? or trick 3?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more tricks, and they must come from ♣s. So you must drive out the ♣A. The problem is that when the defenders win the ♣A they may also take 4 ♠ tricks.

While you cannot guarantee the contract you can at least give yourself a better chance by holding up your ♠A on the first trick, and also on West's ♠.

Now you drive out the ♣A. There are four possibilities: East may win the ♣A and cash two more ♠s, down 1. East may win the ♣A and cash just one ♠s, you make it. West may win the ♣A and have a fourth ♠ to lead, you make it. West may win the ♣A and be out of ♠s, you make it.

If you win the first or second ♠ trick you will fail. When you attack ♣s, West will win the ♣A and play a ♠.

Holding up twice can never hurt, and in this case it is the only way to make the contract.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 8 6 4 2

♥ 4

♦ K 6 5 3

♣ 8 3

♠ K 7

♥ J 10 9 8

♦ J 9 7 2

♣ Q 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 5

♥ A Q 6 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ A J 7 4

♠ A Q 3

♥ K 7 5 3

♦ 10 8

♣ K 10 6 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by East

5Count losers in the long-trump hand, (dummy this time).

In the pre-transfer days you would have bid 2♠ with this hand and partner would have passed. Now you make partner bid the ♠s first by saying 2♥. Partner dutifully replies 2♠.

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You say pass.

The contract would be 2♠ played by West.

East plays 2♠. South leads the ♣2. North plays the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A.

Loser List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total =

You can make the contract if you just force out their big trumps. But there is another tempting possibility. You could enter dummy with the ♦K and play the ♥4, finessing North for the ♥K. If the finesse is successful you could then discard dummy's ♣ loser on the ♥A.

Should you or shouldn't you?

The reward for this play would be an overtrick. The price of failure would be going down in a cold contract. So obviously, at rubber bridge, you would be foolish to take such a risk. Playing Duplicate though, you **might** consider it. But let's say you decide to play safe.

Win the ♣A and play a trump. As soon as you get in play another trump. The defenders will no doubt take their ♣ winner when they get in. North will no doubt win one of those high trump tricks, and he MAY lead a ♥ when he gets in. There you will be, trying to decide again whether to finesse . . .

As you see, the ♥K is in the wrong place this time, but might be right the next time.

Usually you should not risk your contract for the sake of an overtrick.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 7 3

♥ 6 4 2

♦ 9 5

♣ Q 9 5

♠ J 4

♥ A 9 8 5

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ K 8 2



♠ A 9 2

♥ J 10 7 3

♦ A 6 4

♣ J 6 3

♠ K 6 5

♥ K Q

♦ K Q 8 2

♣ A 10 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

You need 3 more tricks, and they must come from ♦s. So you must drive out the ♦A. The problem is that when the defenders win the ♦A they may also take 4 ♠ tricks.

This is another case where you should hold up. Allow EW to win the second trick and take your ♠K only at trick #3.

Now you drive out the ♦A. If West has it and also started with 5 ♠s you will go down. But if East has the ♦A you will make the contract no matter how ♠s split.

If you win the second ♠ East will still have a ♠ when he wins the ♦A.

But if you hold up your ♠K East will have no ♠ to put his partner in with.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman convention. With no 4-card Major suit your response is 2♦. Partner now bids 2NT.

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The 2NT bid is invitational, asking you to bid game with a maximum, pass with a minimum. You have 17 points so you bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠7. You put on dummy's ♠J, but East wins the ♠A then continues with the ♠9. Do you play your ♠K now?

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 6

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 8 5
 ♥ A 2
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ A K Q 7 2

♠ J 7 4 3
 ♥ K J 9 5
 ♦ Q 9 5
 ♣ 8 5



♠ Q 9
 ♥ 8 4 3
 ♦ K J 10 8 2
 ♣ J 10 4

♠ A 10 6 2
 ♥ Q 10 7 6
 ♦ 6 4
 ♣ 9 6 3

West	North	East	South
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			

Even if you wanted to show your ♦ suit how would you do it? If you bid 3♦ it would be a transfer and if you bid 4♦ you would have bypassed 3NT, your probable best contract.

But you didn't want to bid them anyway, you just wanted to bid 3NT, right?

The contract would be 3NT played by East.

North leads ♥5, South plays the ♥Q.

The first thing you need to decide is whether to hold up on the ♥.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 5 :: Total = 8

First decide the holdup question. North led the ♥5 and you can see the ♥4, ♥3 and ♥2. Assuming North led fourth down he must have only a 4-card suit since there are no cards he could have lower than the ♥5. With ♥s splitting 4-4 a holdup would do no good, and isn't necessary anyway.

So take the ♥A. Then what?

You COULD try the ♦ finesse. Even if it loses it would establish several ♦ winners. However, if the defenders win just 1 ♦ trick they will quickly grab their 3 ♥ tricks and their ♠A and put you down 1.

This is why it is important to You need just one additional winner and all you have to do to get it is play a ♠ honor.

When you can see all four hands, including the location of the ♦Q, it kind of makes you wished you had finessed and gotten all those overtricks.

Good Bridge players like to take tricks, but they are not greedy.